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"I got 99 problems" says Kanye West in the trailer of Battlefield 3, which led gamers – especially us Indians – to reflect on how we have our own share of problems in this country, and here are a few.

Expensive!

Everyone needs hardware to game on, and even that very first hurdle turns into a stumbling block in our country as decent hardware is priced quite high and out of reach for most people. This initial expenditure alone throws a lot of potential gamers off, as not many can afford it.

Sorry no repairs

Even when you do fork out the cash for a console, you're heavily



We, the unfortunate

Our land isn't the best of environments for gamers to thrive in, be it casual or hardcore. We looked to our team – and also our community – for inputs and the result is this list of 10 reasons why being a gamer sucks in India.

dependent on your warranty because there aren't any official service centres that repair consoles here. If something goes wrong with your unit – and if you're lucky it will be within the warranty period – you get a replacement free of cost, but what happens after your warranty period expires? Xbox 360 owners have to go out and buy another console, and Sony offers a pretty hefty discount for those who trade in their dead, out of warranty consoles for a new one. That's all well and good, but it's still yet another expenditure on top of the initial investment.

How much???

Once you've got your hardware in place, there comes the recurring expense known as game purchases. For

most people ₹2,500 for a game is way over what they're willing to pay and for some even the ₹999 for PC games is too much. The reason being game prices are directly translated without taking purchasing power parity into account. The value of the \$60 dollars an American spends on buying a copy of his favourite game might not be as high for him as it is for an Indian who pays ₹2,499 for his. This pricing strategy, unfortunately pushes many people onto the path of piracy, though we don't condone pirates' actions in the least.

A way to combat this might be to get games packaged in India, which will lower the customs duty laid on the currently packaged software, like it has for PC and PS2 games, something we'll get to later.



Overpriced oldies

An extension of the previous reason, prices for old games don't fall frequently enough here. If you were living in a first-world country and weren't interested in paying full-price for a game, you could wait for a while and the prices would start dropping, at which point you could pick it up.